

Week 5 - Task 14: Threat Intelligence & IOCs

Intern: Mudasir Zia **Company:** TechBiz Academy — Cybersecurity Internship **Date:** September 19, 2026

1. Objective

Understand core IOC (Indicator of Compromise) types and practice checking a suspicious IP and a file hash using free threat-intel tools (AbuseIPDB, VirusTotal), then issue a verdict.

2. IOC Types

Type	Example	Use
IP Address	185.220.101.1	Identify malicious hosts, scanners, C2 servers
Domain	evil-domain.com	Phishing/malware delivery infrastructure
URL	http://bad-site.com/payload	Malicious links, drop sites
File Hash (MD5/SHA1/SHA256)	ae8aef24bb...ca279d	Uniquely identify a file regardless of name, check against malware databases

3. IP Reputation Check — AbuseIPDB

IP checked: 185.220.101.1

Field	Result
Abuse Confidence	100%
Total Reports	6,993 reports from 834 distinct sources
First Reported	November 21, 2020
Last Reported	6 hours ago (still active)
Type	Tor exit node
ISP / Location	Artikel10 e.V. — Berlin, Germany
Reported Categories	Hacking, Web App Attack, DDoS, Brute-Force, SSH abuse, Phishing, Port Scan

Finding: This IP is a known Tor exit node with a long, continuous history of SSH brute-force, WAF-blocked attacks, DDoS, and phishing-related activity across hundreds of independent reporters. 100% confidence + recent activity (6 hrs ago) = actively malicious infrastructure, not a one-off false positive.

4. File Hash Check — VirusTotal

Hash checked:

ae8aef24bb22b072a359202d791eb4251681f3aa44556a7817dc3dcc88ca279d

Field	Result
Detection	0 / 60 vendors flagged malicious
File	New Text Document (4).txt, 66 B
Verdict shown	"No security vendors flagged this file as malicious"

Finding: This is a clean, benign text file — correctly demonstrates the VirusTotal hash-lookup workflow used to triage suspicious file hashes before opening/executing them.

5. Overall Verdict

- **IP 185.220.101.1 → Malicious / High-Risk.** Block at firewall level, treat any traffic to/from it as suspicious (Tor exit + confirmed attack history).
- **File hash → Benign.** No further action needed.

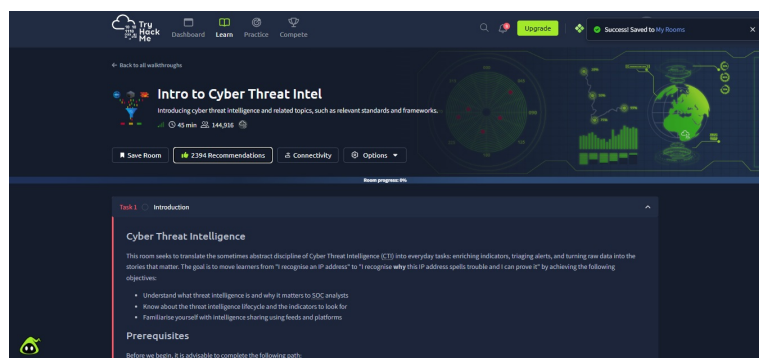
This mirrors real SOC L1 triage: cross-check every unknown IOC against reputation sources before deciding, and don't assume "unknown" means "safe."

6. TryHackMe Rooms Completed (Proof)

Both mandatory free-tier rooms completed: - **Intro to Cyber Threat Intel - Threat Intelligence Tools**

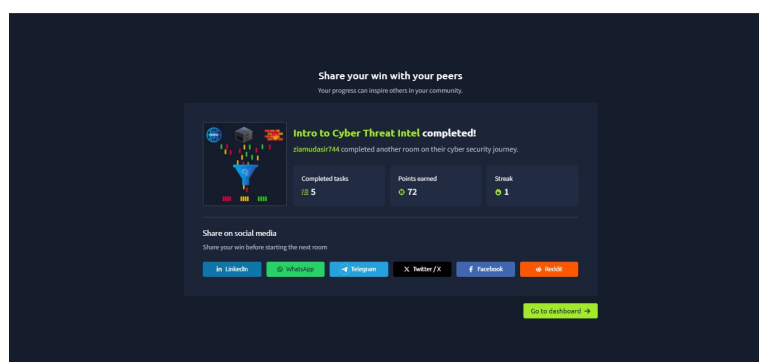
7. Screenshots

TryHackMe — Intro to Cyber Threat Intel (Room Start)



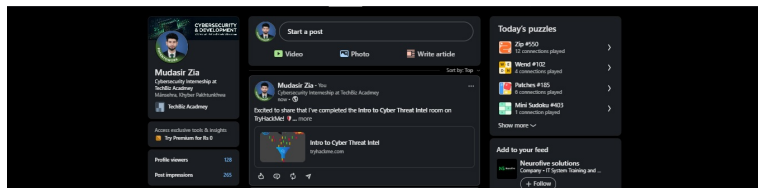
Room Start

TryHackMe — Room Completed (5 tasks, 72 points)



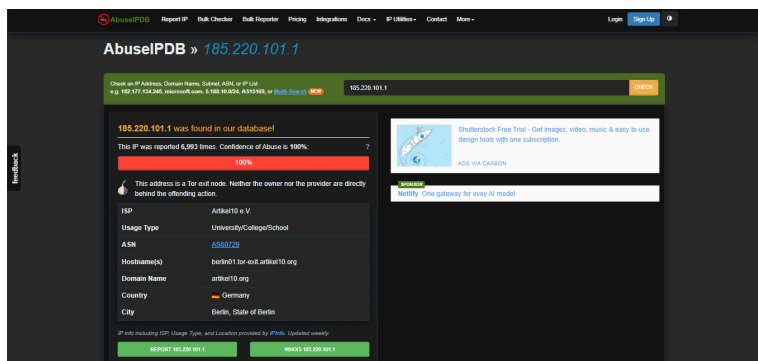
Room Completed

Completion Proof (LinkedIn)



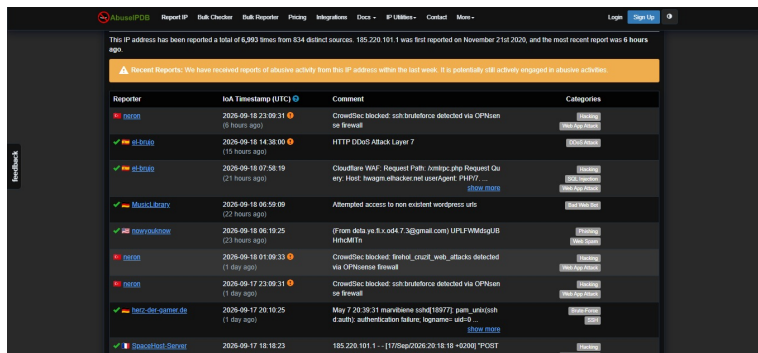
LinkedIn Proof

AbuseIPDB — IP Reputation Summary



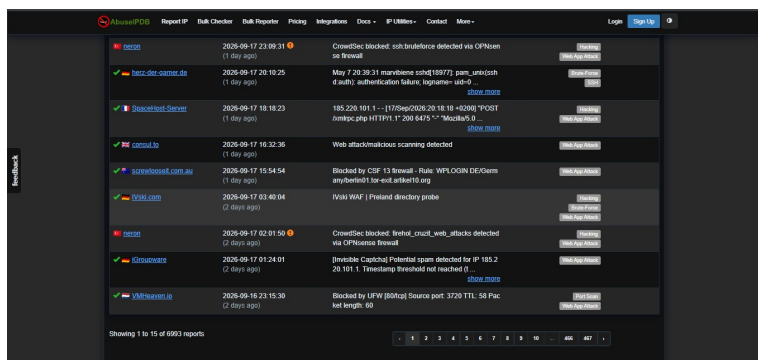
AbuseIPDB Summary

AbuseIPDB — Report History (Page 1)

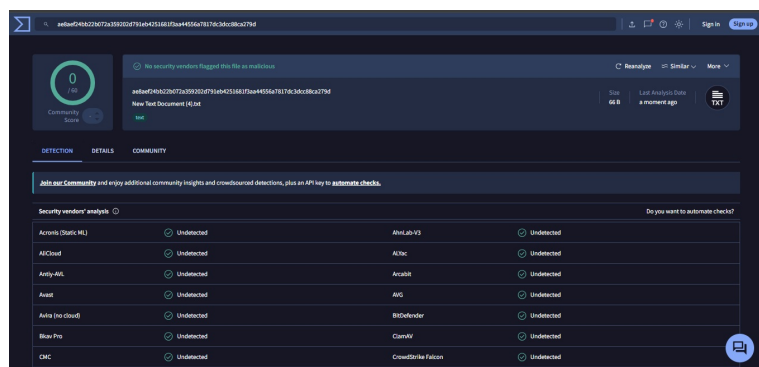


AbuseIPDB Reports 1

AbuseIPDB — Report History (Page 2)



VirusTotal — Hash Detection Summary



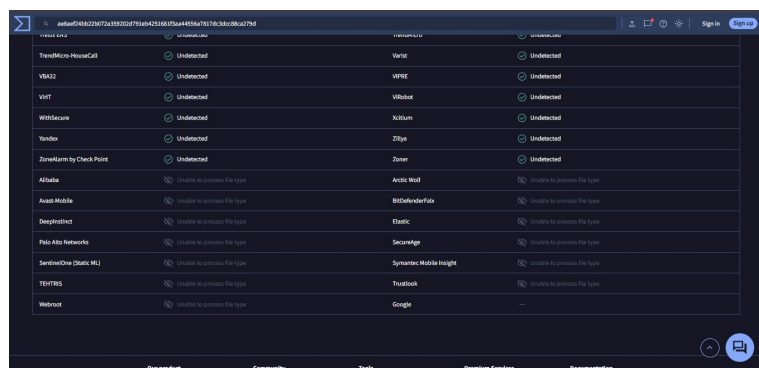
VirusTotal Summary

VirusTotal — Vendor List (Part 1)



VirusTotal Vendors 1

VirusTotal — Vendor List (Part 2)



VirusTotal Vendors 2

End of report.